

# Chapter 4 - VideoChip

VideoChip is the IE's general-purpose framebuffer chip. It sits at the bottom of the compositor stack (layer 0) and provides three things: a framebuffer in main memory, a programmable raster engine called the **copper list**, and a 2D drawing accelerator called the **blitter**. From BASIC, use POKE for raw register programming and the BLIT and COPPER commands for the common accelerated paths. From machine code, ordinary stores to the same MMIO registers do the same work.

## 4.1 Where the picture lives

VideoChip reads its picture from a region of main memory called **VRAM**. VRAM is a five-megabyte region that begins at byte address \$00100000 (1 MB) and ends at \$005FFFFFF. Any byte in that region is visible to the chip on the next frame.

```
+-----+
|  VRAM  |
| $00100000 .. $005FFFFFF |
|  5 MB  |
+-----+
```

Five megabytes is enough to hold several frames at the smaller modes (a  $960 \times 540$  RGBA frame is 2,073,600 bytes, so two such frames fit with room to spare), but **not** enough for one full  $1920 \times 1080$  RGBA frame, which requires 8,294,400 bytes. In the  $1920 \times 1080$  mode, point FB\_BASE at a region of ordinary main memory large enough for one frame, instead of into VRAM.

The chip does not own VRAM exclusively. Any CPU can read and write the same bytes. When the compositor builds the next frame, it picks up whatever was last written.

## 4.2 The register block

Every VideoChip register is a 32-bit word at a fixed address. The block begins at \$000F0000 and ends at \$000F049B. All registers are aligned to 4 bytes.

| Address | Name          | Purpose                                        |
|---------|---------------|------------------------------------------------|
| \$F0000 | VIDEO_CTRL    | Master enable. 0 = off, non-zero = on.         |
| \$F0004 | VIDEO_MODE    | Output mode (table below).                     |
| \$F0008 | VIDEO_STATUS  | Status bits (read-only).                       |
| \$F000C | COPPER_CTRL   | Copper enable and reset.                       |
| \$F0010 | COPPER_PTR    | Base address of copper program in main memory. |
| \$F0014 | COPPER_PC     | Copper program counter (read-only).            |
| \$F0018 | COPPER_STATUS | Copper status bits (read-only).                |
| \$F001C | BLT_CTRL      | Blitter start and IRQ enable.                  |
| \$F0020 | BLT_OP        | Blitter operation.                             |
| \$F0024 | BLT_SRC       | Blitter source address.                        |

| Address         | Name                | Purpose                                                       |
|-----------------|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| \$F0028         | BLT_DST             | Blitter destination address.                                  |
| \$F002C         | BLT_WIDTH           | Blitter rectangle width in pixels, or byte count for MEMCOPY. |
| \$F0030         | BLT_HEIGHT          | Blitter rectangle height in rows.                             |
| \$F0034         | BLT_SRC_STRIDE      | Source stride in bytes per row.                               |
| \$F0038         | BLT_DST_STRIDE      | Destination stride in bytes per row.                          |
| \$F003C         | BLT_COLOR           | Fill colour or line colour.                                   |
| \$F0040         | BLT_MASK            | Per-pixel mask for masked copies.                             |
| \$F0044         | BLT_STATUS          | Blitter status bits (read-only).                              |
| \$F0048         | VIDEO_RASTER_Y      | First scanline for the raster band.                           |
| \$F004C         | VIDEO_RASTER_HEIGHT | Raster band height.                                           |
| \$F0050         | VIDEO_RASTER_COLOR  | Raster band fill colour.                                      |
| \$F0054         | VIDEO_RASTER_CTRL   | Raster band start (write 1).                                  |
| \$F0058         | BLT_MODE7_U0        | Mode 7 texture origin (U).                                    |
| \$F005C         | BLT_MODE7_V0        | Mode 7 texture origin (V).                                    |
| \$F0060         | BLT_MODE7_DU_COL    | Mode 7 U step per column.                                     |
| \$F0064         | BLT_MODE7_DV_COL    | Mode 7 V step per column.                                     |
| \$F0068         | BLT_MODE7_DU_ROW    | Mode 7 U step per row.                                        |
| \$F006C         | BLT_MODE7_DV_ROW    | Mode 7 V step per row.                                        |
| \$F0070         | BLT_MODE7_TEX_W     | Mode 7 U wrap mask (width - 1).                               |
| \$F0074         | BLT_MODE7_TEX_H     | Mode 7 V wrap mask (height - 1).                              |
| \$F0078         | PAL_INDEX           | Auto-incrementing palette write index (0-255).                |
| \$F007C         | PAL_DATA            | Palette data port. Writes entry, advances PAL_INDEX.          |
| \$F0080         | COLOR_MODE          | 0 = RGBA32 direct, non-zero = CLUT8 indexed.                  |
| \$F0084         | FB_BASE             | Byte address in main memory where the framebuffer begins.     |
| \$F0088-\$F0487 | PAL_TABLE           | Direct palette window: 256 entries of 4 bytes each.           |
| \$F0488         | BLT_FLAGS           | Blitter BPP and draw-mode flags.                              |
| \$F048C         | BLT_FG              | Blitter foreground colour for colour-expand.                  |
| \$F0490         | BLT_BG              | Blitter background colour for colour-expand.                  |
| \$F0494         | BLT_MASK_MOD        | Mask-row stride for colour-expand.                            |
| \$F0498         | BLT_MASK_SRCX       | Mask source X offset.                                         |

Most setup registers read back the value last staged by the program. Status registers report live state. BLT\_STATUS is the exception to the read-only rule: writing bit 2 clears a pending blitter interrupt.

## 4.3 Enabling the chip and choosing a mode

VideoChip starts disabled. To turn it on, write a non-zero value to VIDEO\_CTRL. To turn it off, write 0.

The chip supports eight output modes. Each mode selects a frame width and height. The default mode at power-on is \$07 (960 × 540).

| Value | Mode        |
|-------|-------------|
| \$00  | 640 × 480   |
| \$01  | 800 × 600   |
| \$02  | 1024 × 768  |
| \$03  | 1280 × 960  |
| \$04  | 320 × 200   |
| \$05  | 320 × 240   |
| \$06  | 1920 × 1080 |
| \$07  | 960 × 540   |

Write the desired value into VIDEO\_MODE. The chip resizes its internal framebuffer and notifies the compositor. Writing a value outside the table is ignored.

Below is a BASIC fragment that turns the chip on at 960 × 540 and sets the framebuffer base at the start of VRAM:

```
10 POKE &H000F0004, &H07      : REM VIDEO_MODE = 960 BY 540
20 POKE &H000F0084, &H00100000 : REM FB_BASE  = VRAM start
30 POKE &H000F0000, 1          : REM VIDEO_CTRL = on
```

POKE writes the four bytes of a 32-bit word at the given aligned address (see Chapter 2).

## 4.4 The framebuffer

FB\_BASE is the byte address in main memory where the chip reads the first pixel of the picture. The chip reads W × H pixels in left-to-right, top-to-bottom order, where W and H are the width and height of the current mode.

There are two pixel formats, selected by COLOR\_MODE:

| COLOR_MODE | Pixel format         | Bytes per pixel |
|------------|----------------------|-----------------|
| 0          | RGBA32 direct colour | 4               |
| non-zero   | CLUT8 indexed colour | 1               |

In **RGBA32** mode every pixel is four bytes, little-endian, in the order red, green, blue, alpha. The compositor uses the alpha byte for mask blending as described in Chapter 3.

When you write an RGBA32 pixel with BASIC POKE, remember that POKE writes a 32-bit little-endian word: alpha in the high byte, then blue, green, and red in the low byte. BASIC examples often use values below &H01000000, such as &H000000FF for red, because those integers are exact in BASIC's numeric format. The compositor still treats any non-black direct-colour pixel as opaque.

In **CLUT8** mode every pixel is one byte, which is an index into the 256-entry CLUT palette. The chip expands each index into an RGBA32 pixel on the fly. The alpha byte produced by the expansion is always \$FF (fully opaque).

FB\_BASE may be set anywhere in main memory. There is no requirement to point it at the VRAM window; any address that holds  $W \times H \times \text{bytes-per-pixel}$  bytes of valid data works. Pointing it into VRAM means writes through ordinary memory stores update the picture immediately.

## 4.5 The palette

The palette has 256 entries. Each entry is a 24-bit RGB triple packed in the low three bytes of a 32-bit word:

|          |         |         |         |         |
|----------|---------|---------|---------|---------|
| bit 31   | 24 23   | 16 15   | 8 7     | 0       |
| +-----+  | +-----+ | +-----+ | +-----+ | +-----+ |
| reserved | red     | green   | blue    |         |
| +-----+  | +-----+ | +-----+ | +-----+ | +-----+ |

There are two ways to set palette entries.

**Indexed port.** Write the entry number (0-255) to PAL\_INDEX. Then write each entry's 24-bit value to PAL\_DATA. The chip stores the value, increments PAL\_INDEX, and wraps at 256. This is the shortest way to load a whole palette:

```
100 POKE &H000F0078, 0      : REM PAL_INDEX = 0
110 POKE &H000F007C, &HFF0000 : REM entry 0 = red
120 POKE &H000F007C, &H00FF00 : REM entry 1 = green
130 POKE &H000F007C, &H0000FF : REM entry 2 = blue
```

**Direct window.** Each entry is also visible at PAL\_TABLE + index\*4. Writing the word at that address updates entry index and leaves PAL\_INDEX unchanged. Use this when you want to set a single entry without disturbing a write cursor.

The palette is shared between CLUT8 picture display and the blitter's colour-expand operation.

## 4.6 The blitter

The framebuffer and palette are enough for pixels you place yourself. The blitter is for work you would rather not do one pixel at a time: moving rectangles, building sprites from masks, expanding 1-bit templates, scaling pictures, drawing lines, and treating a texture as a rotating floor. Think of this section as the VideoChip's workbench. The tables give the exact knobs; each example shows the visible job those knobs do.

The blitter is VideoChip's 2D drawing engine. It can copy memory, fill rectangles, draw lines, apply raster operations, expand 1-bit templates, alpha-blend sprites, scale bitmaps, and run the Mode 7 affine texture unit. BASIC exposes the common copy, fill, line, memcpy, wait, and Mode 7 paths through BLIT. The other operations are still native to the machine: enter them with POKE to the blitter registers.

The blitter is synchronous. Starting it with BLT\_CTRL.START runs the operation before the POKE or machine-code store returns. A program may still poll BLT\_STATUS or use BLIT WAIT; in normal BASIC use the operation has already finished.

### 4.6.1 Blitter registers and start sequence

Every blitter operation uses the same staged-register model. Writes to BLT\_SRC, BLT\_DST, BLT\_WIDTH, and the other setup registers prepare the next operation. Writing 1 to BLT\_CTRL latches those values and starts the transfer.

| Register | Used for                                                                                                    |
|----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| BLT_CTRL | Bit 0 starts the operation. Bit 2 enables blitter IRQs. Reads return BUSY in bit 1 and IRQ-enable in bit 2. |
| BLT_OP   | Operation number, 0-8.                                                                                      |

| Register       | Used for                                                                                                    |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| BLT_SRC        | Source address, or packed start coordinate for legacy line drawing.                                         |
| BLT_DST        | Destination address, or packed end coordinate for legacy line drawing.                                      |
| BLT_WIDTH      | Width in pixels for rectangles, source width for scale, or packed end coordinate for extended line drawing. |
| BLT_HEIGHT     | Height in pixels for rectangles, source height for scale.                                                   |
| BLT_SRC_STRIDE | Source bytes per row. 0 means a default stride.                                                             |
| BLT_DST_STRIDE | Destination bytes per row. 0 means a default stride.                                                        |
| BLT_COLOR      | Fill/line colour, or packed scale destination size.                                                         |
| BLT_MASK       | Mask/template address.                                                                                      |
| BLT_FLAGS      | Pixel size, draw mode, and colour-expand flags.                                                             |
| BLT_FG, BLT_BG | Foreground and background colours for colour-expand.                                                        |
| BLT_MASK_MOD   | Template bytes to advance after each colour-expand row.                                                     |
| BLT_MASK_SRCX  | First template bit X offset for colour-expand.                                                              |

General raw-register sequence:

1. Write BLT\_OP.
2. Write operation-specific setup registers.
3. Write BLT\_FLAGS if the operation needs CLUT8, draw modes, or colour-expand flags. Leave it at 0 for the default RGBA32 copy mode.
4. Write 1 to BLT\_CTRL.
5. Read BLT\_STATUS if you need to check DONE, ERR, or IRQ\_PENDING.

BLT\_SRC\_STRIDE and BLT\_DST\_STRIDE are bytes, not pixels. If a stride register is 0, the blitter chooses a default. For VRAM destinations the default is the current framebuffer row width (mode width \* bytes-per-pixel). For non-VRAM bitmaps the default is the rectangle width times bytes per pixel.

## 4.6.2 Operations

| BLT_OP | Operation    | Reader path            | Summary                                                                 |
|--------|--------------|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0      | COPY         | BLIT COPY or POKE      | Copy a rectangle.                                                       |
| 1      | FILL         | BLIT FILL or POKE      | Fill a rectangle with BLT_COLOR.                                        |
| 2      | LINE         | BLIT LINE or POKE      | Draw a Bresenham line.                                                  |
| 3      | MASKED_COPY  | POKE                   | Copy RGBA32 source pixels where a 1-bit mask is set.                    |
| 4      | ALPHA_COPY   | POKE                   | Copy or blend RGBA32 source pixels using source alpha.                  |
| 5      | MODE7        | BLIT MODE7 or POKE     | Affine RGBA32 texture mapper.                                           |
| 6      | COLOR_EXPAND | POKE                   | Expand a 1-bit template into CLUT8 or RGBA32 pixels.                    |
| 7      | SCALE        | POKE                   | Nearest-neighbour scale from source rectangle to destination rectangle. |
| 8      | MEMCOPY      | BLIT MEMCOPY or BLIT M | Copy a byte-counted linear memory span.                                 |

### 4.6.3 BLT\_FLAGS

BLT\_FLAGS controls bytes per pixel and raster operation for the copy, fill, scale, colour-expand, and extended line paths.

| Bits | Field           | Meaning                                                             |
|------|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1-0  | BPP             | 0 = RGBA32, 1 = CLUT8. Other values currently behave as RGBA32.     |
| 7-4  | Draw mode       | Raster operation number, table below.                               |
| 8    | JAM1            | Colour-expand: clear template bits leave destination unchanged.     |
| 9    | Invert template | Colour-expand: flip each template bit before use.                   |
| 10   | Invert mode     | Colour-expand: set template bits XOR the destination with all ones. |

If BLT\_FLAGS is 0, the draw mode is treated as COPY (3) for compatibility. Otherwise, the draw-mode field is used exactly.

| Mode | Name         | Result                       |
|------|--------------|------------------------------|
| 0    | Clear        | 0                            |
| 1    | And          | source AND destination       |
| 2    | AndReverse   | source AND NOT destination   |
| 3    | Copy         | source                       |
| 4    | AndInverted  | NOT source AND destination   |
| 5    | NoOp         | destination                  |
| 6    | Xor          | source XOR destination       |
| 7    | Or           | source OR destination        |
| 8    | Nor          | NOT (source OR destination)  |
| 9    | Equiv        | NOT (source XOR destination) |
| 10   | Invert       | NOT destination              |
| 11   | OrReverse    | source OR NOT destination    |
| 12   | CopyInverted | NOT source                   |
| 13   | OrInverted   | NOT source OR destination    |
| 14   | Nand         | NOT (source AND destination) |
| 15   | Set          | all bits set                 |

To build a flags word by hand:

```
flags = bpp + drawmode * 16
```

For example, RGBA32 XOR is  $0 + 6 \cdot 16 = 96$ . CLUT8 copy is  $1 + 3 \cdot 16 = 49$ .

### 4.6.4 Status, errors, and IRQs

BLT\_STATUS carries three bits:

| Bit | Name | Meaning                                             |
|-----|------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| 0   | ERR  | Last operation failed or detected an invalid setup. |

| Bit | Name        | Meaning                       |
|-----|-------------|-------------------------------|
| 1   | DONE        | Last operation completed.     |
| 2   | IRQ_PENDING | Blitter interrupt is pending. |

Starting a blit clears ERR and DONE, then sets DONE after the operation finishes. Invalid operation numbers set ERR. Scale sets ERR for zero sizes, out-of-range rectangles, and visible RGBA32 VRAM writes that are not 4-byte aligned. Mode 7 sets ERR for invalid texture masks or out-of-range texture reads. Rectangle copy and fill also set ERR when a visible RGBA32 VRAM destination is misaligned or beyond the displayed framebuffer.

To request an interrupt, write `BLT_CTRL = 5 (START + IRQ_ENABLE)` instead of 1. The operation still completes synchronously, and `BLT_STATUS`. `IRQ_PENDING` is set. Clear the pending bit by writing 4 to `BLT_STATUS`.

## 4.6.5 COPY and MEMCOPY

`COPY` transfers a rectangle from `BLT_SRC` to `BLT_DST`.

| Register                    | Meaning                                      |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| <code>BLT_SRC</code>        | Source base address.                         |
| <code>BLT_DST</code>        | Destination base address.                    |
| <code>BLT_WIDTH</code>      | Width in pixels for RGBA32/CLUT8 rectangles. |
| <code>BLT_HEIGHT</code>     | Height in rows.                              |
| <code>BLT_SRC_STRIDE</code> | Source bytes per row.                        |
| <code>BLT_DST_STRIDE</code> | Destination bytes per row.                   |
| <code>BLT_FLAGS</code>      | Pixel size and draw mode.                    |

`BLIT COPY src,dst,w,h` uses operation 0. Add both strides when the source or destination is a small off-screen bitmap rather than a full framebuffer row:

```
BLIT COPY src, dst, w, h, srcStride, dstStride
```

`BLIT MEMCOPY src,dst,len` and its shorthand `BLIT M src,dst,len` select operation 8. This is not a rectangle copy. It copies `len` bytes from `src` to `dst` as one linear span. `BLT_SRC`, `BLT_DST`, and `BLT_WIDTH` are the registers that matter. `BLT_HEIGHT`, `BLT_SRC_STRIDE`, `BLT_DST_STRIDE`, and `BLT_FLAGS` are ignored by the hardware operation, although the BASIC keyword stores 1 in `BLT_HEIGHT` and `len` in both stride registers before it starts the blitter.

Use `COPY` when the source is a rectangle with a row stride. Use `MEMCOPY` when the source is a flat block, such as a saved RGBA screen, a work buffer, or a full back buffer. The length is always bytes. A 640 by 480 RGBA32 screen is therefore 640\*480\*4, or 1228800 bytes.

## MEMCOPY back buffer

This listing fills an off-screen buffer, copies it into the visible framebuffer, then prints the blitter status:

```
10 FB=&H00100000:BB=&H00230000:ST=640*4
20 POKE &H000F0004,0:POKE &H000F0080,0:POKE &H000F0000,1
30 BLIT FILL BB,640,480,&H00002040,ST
40 BLIT MEMCOPY BB,FB,640*480*4
50 PRINT PEEK(&H000F0044)
```

The screen shows the filled buffer after line 40. The status print is 2, meaning DONE is set and ERR is clear.

Overlapping RAM and VRAM copies preserve the original source bytes in the normal memory paths. For portable programs, still prefer non-overlapping source and destination spans unless you are deliberately moving a buffer in place.

### 4.6.6 FILL

FILL writes BLT\_COLOR over a destination rectangle. In RGBA32 mode the whole word is written. In CLUT8 mode only the low byte is used.

| Register       | Meaning                    |
|----------------|----------------------------|
| BLT_DST        | Destination base address.  |
| BLT_WIDTH      | Width in pixels.           |
| BLT_HEIGHT     | Height in rows.            |
| BLT_DST_STRIDE | Destination bytes per row. |
| BLT_COLOR      | Fill value.                |
| BLT_FLAGS      | Pixel size and draw mode.  |

BLIT FILL dst,w,h,colour[,stride] is the BASIC form. If the draw mode is not COPY, the fill value is combined with the destination through the selected raster operation.

### 4.6.7 LINE

LINE draws a Bresenham line.

The BASIC form is:

```
BLIT LINE x0, y0, x1, y1, colour
```

This is the legacy line path. BLT\_SRC packs the start coordinate as  $x0 + y0 * 65536$ ; BLT\_DST packs the end coordinate the same way. The destination base is fixed at VRAM start, and the line is clipped to the current VideoChip mode.

For a custom bitmap base, CLUT8 lines, or draw modes, use extended line mode by setting BLT\_FLAGS non-zero:

| Register       | Meaning in extended line mode                                     |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| BLT_SRC        | $x0 + y0 * 65536$ .                                               |
| BLT_WIDTH      | $x1 + y1 * 65536$ .                                               |
| BLT_DST        | Destination bitmap base address.                                  |
| BLT_DST_STRIDE | Destination row stride in bytes.                                  |
| BLT_COLOR      | Line colour or CLUT8 index.                                       |
| BLT_FLAGS      | BPP and draw mode. Must be non-zero to select extended line mode. |

Extended line mode does not clip to a viewport. Clip coordinates before starting the blit.

### 4.6.8 MASKED\_COPY

MASKED\_COPY is an RGBA32 sprite copy controlled by a 1-bit mask. It ignores BLT\_FLAGS.



| Register                       | Meaning                             |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| BLT_SRC                        | RGBA32 source base.                 |
| BLT_DST                        | RGBA32 destination base.            |
| BLT_WIDTH, BLT_HEIGHT          | Rectangle size in pixels.           |
| BLT_SRC_STRIDE, BLT_DST_STRIDE | Source and destination row strides. |
| BLT_MASK                       | 1-bit mask base address.            |

Mask bits are packed least-significant-bit first. Pixel  $x$  reads bit  $(x \bmod 8)$  from byte  $\text{BLT\_MASK} + x/8$ . A set bit copies the source pixel. A clear bit leaves the destination unchanged. The mask row stride is fixed to  $(\text{width} + 7) / 8$  bytes.

This example draws a small diamond sprite. The source is an ordinary  $8 \times 8$  RGBA32 square, but the mask lets only the diamond-shaped part through:

```

10 REM MASKED COPY DIAMOND
20 FB=&H00100000:SPR=&H00600000:MSK=&H00610000
30 ST=320*4:SS=8*4
40 POKE &H000F0004,&H04
50 POKE &H000F0080,0
60 POKE &H000F0084,FB
70 POKE &H000F0000,1
80 BLIT FILL FB,320,200,&H00001020,ST
90 BLIT FILL SPR,8,8,&H000000FF,SS
100 BLIT FILL SPR+2*SS+2*4,4,4,&H0000FFFF,SS
110 DATA 24,60,126,255,255,126,60,24
120 FOR Y=0 TO 7
130 READ M
140 POKE8 MSK+Y,M
150 NEXT Y
160 POKE &H000F0024,SPR
170 POKE &H000F0028,FB+80*ST+156*4
180 POKE &H000F002C,8
190 POKE &H000F0030,8
200 POKE &H000F0034,SS
210 POKE &H000F0038,ST
220 POKE &H000F0040,MSK
230 POKE &H000F0020,3
240 POKE &H000F001C,1
250 PRINT PEEK(&H000F0044)

```

The sprite and mask live in ordinary main memory. The mask bytes in line 110 are decimal forms of \$18,\$3C,\$7E,\$FF,\$FF,\$7E,\$3C,\$18. Lines 120-150 write them with POKE8 because the mask is a byte stream, not a table of 32-bit words. The final PRINT should show 2.

### 4.6.9 ALPHA\_COPY

ALPHA\_COPY is an RGBA32 sprite copy with source alpha. It ignores BLT\_FLAGS.

| Source alpha | Result                                            |
|--------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| 0            | Leave destination unchanged.                      |
| 255          | Copy source pixel exactly.                        |
| 1-254        | Blend source over destination with integer alpha. |

The blend is per channel:

```
out = (source * alpha + destination * (255 - alpha)) / 255
```

This is different from the compositor rule in Chapter 3. For ALPHA\_COPY, a pixel such as \$00010203 is transparent because its alpha byte is zero.

This example writes a translucent red sprite one byte at a time so the alpha byte is exact. The blitter blends it over a dark blue background:

```
10 REM ALPHA COPY GLOW
20 FB=&H00100000:SPR=&H00620000
30 ST=320*4:SS=8*4
40 POKE &H000F0004,&H04
50 POKE &H000F0080,0
60 POKE &H000F0084,FB
70 POKE &H000F0000,1
80 BLIT FILL FB,320,200,&H00400000,ST
90 FOR Y=0 TO 7
100 FOR X=0 TO 7
110 A=SPR+(Y*8+X)*4
120 POKE8 A,255:POKE8 A+1,0:POKE8 A+2,0:POKE8 A+3,128
130 NEXT X:NEXT Y
140 POKE &H000F0024,SPR
150 POKE &H000F0028,FB+96*ST+156*4
160 POKE &H000F002C,8
170 POKE &H000F0030,8
180 POKE &H000F0034,SS
190 POKE &H000F0038,ST
200 POKE &H000F0020,4
210 POKE &H000F001C,1
220 PRINT PEEK(&H000F0044)
```

Line 120 stores red, green, blue, and alpha bytes. The alpha value 128 makes the source about half opaque. The final PRINT should show 2.

## 4.6.10 COLOR\_EXPAND

COLOR\_EXPAND turns a 1-bit template into pixels. This is useful for software fonts, monochrome sprites, stipples, and mask drawing. The operation can write RGBA32 or CLUT8 depending on BLT\_FLAGS.

| Register              | Meaning                                   |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| BLT_MASK              | Template base address.                    |
| BLT_DST               | Destination base address.                 |
| BLT_WIDTH, BLT_HEIGHT | Output size in pixels.                    |
| BLT_DST_STRIDE        | Destination bytes per row.                |
| BLT_FG                | Foreground value for set template bits.   |
| BLT_BG                | Background value for clear template bits. |
| BLT_MASK_MOD          | Template bytes to advance after each row. |
| BLT_MASK_SRCX         | First bit offset in the template row.     |

| Register  | Meaning                                           |
|-----------|---------------------------------------------------|
| BLT_FLAGS | BPP, JAM1, invert-template, and invert-mode bits. |

Template bytes are read most-significant-bit first: bit 7 of the first byte is the leftmost pixel, then bit 6, and so on. If BLT\_MASK\_SRCX is 3, the first output pixel starts at the fourth template bit.

There are three drawing behaviours:

| Flags                        | Set template bit              | Clear template bit          |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| neither JAM1 nor invert-mode | write BLT_FG                  | write BLT_BG                |
| JAM1                         | write BLT_FG                  | leave destination unchanged |
| invert-mode                  | XOR destination with all ones | leave destination unchanged |

Invert-template flips the template bit before the table above is applied.

#### 4.6.11 SCALE

SCALE copies a source rectangle to a destination rectangle using nearest-neighbour sampling. It supports RGBA32 and CLUT8.

| Register                       | Meaning                                                       |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| BLT_SRC                        | Source base address.                                          |
| BLT_DST                        | Destination base address.                                     |
| BLT_WIDTH, BLT_HEIGHT          | Source width and height.                                      |
| BLT_COLOR                      | Destination size: low 16 bits = width, high 16 bits = height. |
| BLT_SRC_STRIDE, BLT_DST_STRIDE | Source and destination row strides.                           |
| BLT_FLAGS                      | BPP. Draw mode is not used by SCALE.                          |

The packed destination size is:

```
BLT_COLOR = dstWidth + dstHeight * 65536
```

Scaling is nearest-neighbour. There is no filtering and no alpha blend.

#### 4.6.12 A useful blitter BASIC example

This program uses the blitter as a drawing tool: it clears a 320 x 200 RGBA32 screen, builds a small off-screen sprite, copies that sprite to several positions, and draws crossing diagonal lines.

```

10 REM VIDEOCHIP BLITTER POSTER
20 FB=&H00100000:SPR=&H00140000
30 W=320:H=200:ST=W*4:SS=16*4
40 POKE &H000F0004,&H04
50 POKE &H000F0080,0
60 POKE &H000F0084,FB
70 POKE &H000F0000,1
80 BLIT FILL FB,W,H,&H00001020,ST
90 BLIT FILL FB+12*ST+20*4,280,40,&H000000AA,ST
100 BLIT FILL FB+58*ST+20*4,280,40,&H0000AA00,ST
110 BLIT FILL FB+104*ST+20*4,280,40,&H00AA0000,ST
120 BLIT FILL SPR,16,16,&H000000FF,SS
130 BLIT FILL SPR+4*SS+4*4,8,8,&H0000FFFF,SS
140 FOR I=0 TO 9
150 X=24+I*28:Y=150+INT(20*SIN(I))
160 BLIT COPY SPR,FB+Y*ST+X*4,16,16,SS,ST
170 NEXT I
180 BLIT LINE 0,0,319,199,&H00FFFFFF
190 BLIT LINE 0,199,319,0,&H00FFFFFF
200 PRINT PEEK(&H000F0044)

```

Line 80 clears the screen. Lines 90-110 draw coloured bands. Lines 120-130 build a 16 x 16 off-screen sprite at SPR. Line 160 copies that sprite into the framebuffer with explicit source and destination strides. The final PRINT should show 2 for BLT\_STATUS.DONE.

#### 4.6.13 A colour-expand example

This raw-register example draws an 8-pixel template row. The template byte \$B0 is binary 10110000, so pixels 0, 2, and 3 use the foreground colour and the rest use the background.

```

10 REM COLOUR EXPAND TEMPLATE
20 FB=&H00100000:TM=&H00300000:ST=320*4
30 POKE &H000F0004,&H04
40 POKE &H000F0080,0
50 POKE &H000F0084,FB
60 POKE &H000F0000,1
70 BLIT FILL FB,320,200,&H00000000,ST
80 POKE8 TM,&HB0
90 POKE &H000F0040,TM
100 POKE &H000F0028,FB+80*ST+120*4
110 POKE &H000F002C,8
120 POKE &H000F0030,1
130 POKE &H000F0038,ST
140 POKE &H000F048C,&H000000FF
150 POKE &H000F0490,&H0000FF00
160 POKE &H000F0494,1
170 POKE &H000F0498,0
180 POKE &H000F0488,48
190 POKE &H000F0020,6
200 POKE &H000F001C,1
210 PRINT PEEK(&H000F0044)

```

Line 80 uses POKE8 because the template is a byte stream. Line 180 writes BLT\_FLAGS = 48, which is RGBA32 plus draw mode 3 (COPY). Line 190 selects COLOR\_EXPAND. Line 200 starts the blitter.

## 4.6.14 A scale example

This example draws a small source square, then scales it to 64 x 64 with raw blitter registers:

```
10 REM NEAREST SCALE
20 FB=&H00100000:SRC=&H00150000:DST=FB+80*320*4+120*4
30 ST=320*4:SS=16*4
40 POKE &H000F0004,&H04
50 POKE &H000F0080,0
60 POKE &H000F0084,FB
70 POKE &H000F0000,1
80 BLIT FILL FB,320,200,&H00000000,ST
90 BLIT FILL SRC,16,16,&H000000CC,SS
100 BLIT FILL SRC+4*SS+4*4,8,8,&H00CCCC00,SS
110 POKE &H000F0024,SRC
120 POKE &H000F0028,DST
130 POKE &H000F002C,16
140 POKE &H000F0030,16
150 POKE &H000F0034,SS
160 POKE &H000F0038,ST
170 POKE &H000F003C,64+64*65536
180 POKE &H000F0488,48
190 POKE &H000F0020,7
200 POKE &H000F001C,1
210 PRINT PEEK(&H000F0044)
```

Line 170 packs destination width and height into BLT\_COLOR. Line 190 selects SCALE.

## 4.6.15 Mode 7 affine texture mapping

BLT\_OP = 5 selects the Mode 7 unit. It renders a rectangular destination by sampling a source texture through an affine transform. For every destination pixel (x,y), the chip computes:

```
U = U0 + x * DU_COL + y * DU_ROW
V = V0 + x * DV_COL + y * DV_ROW
```

U, V, and all four delta registers are signed 16.16 fixed-point numbers:

| Value      | Meaning    |
|------------|------------|
| \$00010000 | 1.0 texel  |
| \$00008000 | 0.5 texel  |
| \$00000000 | 0.0        |
| \$FFFF0000 | -1.0 texel |

The integer texel coordinate is the upper 16 bits. The fractional part gives sub-pixel movement, but sampling is nearest-lower-texel: there is no bilinear filtering. After extracting the integer part, the chip wraps the coordinate with the texture masks:

```
tex_x = (U >> 16) AND BLT_MODE7_TEX_W
tex_y = (V >> 16) AND BLT_MODE7_TEX_H
```

BLT\_MODE7\_TEX\_W and BLT\_MODE7\_TEX\_H are masks, not literal widths. They must be one less than a power of two:

| Texture size | Mask |
|--------------|------|
| 2            | 1    |
| 4            | 3    |
| 8            | 7    |
| 64           | 63   |
| 256          | 255  |

An invalid mask, such as 5, sets BLT\_STATUS bit 0 (ERR) and the blit stops. Negative coordinates wrap naturally through the same mask: -1.0 with mask 3 samples texel 3.

Mode 7 always reads and writes RGBA32 pixels, four bytes per pixel. BLT\_FLAGS does not make Mode 7 operate in CLUT8, and Mode 7 does not use BLT\_COLOR, BLT\_MASK, BLT\_FG, or BLT\_BG.

#### 4.6.16 Mode 7 setup

The raw-register setup order is:

1. Put the RGBA32 texture in memory. Each texel is four bytes.
2. Write BLT\_SRC to the texture base address.
3. Write BLT\_DST to the destination base address.
4. Write BLT\_WIDTH and BLT\_HEIGHT to the destination size in pixels.
5. Write BLT\_SRC\_STRIDE to the texture row stride in bytes, or 0 to use  $(\text{BLT\_MODE7\_TEX\_W} + 1) * 4$ .
6. Write BLT\_DST\_STRIDE to the destination row stride in bytes, or 0 to use the current framebuffer stride when the destination is in VRAM.
7. Write the six transform registers: U0, V0, DU\_COL, DV\_COL, DU\_ROW, DV\_ROW.
8. Write the two texture masks.
9. Write 5 to BLT\_OP.
10. Write 1 to BLT\_CTRL.

The BASIC helper has the same shape:

```
BLIT MODE7 src, dst, w, h, u0, v0, duCol, dvCol, duRow, dvRow, uMask, vMask
BLIT MODE7 src, dst, w, h, u0, v0, duCol, dvCol, duRow, dvRow, uMask, vMask, srcStride,
dstStride
```

The 12-argument form clears both stride registers and uses the defaults. If you supply strides, supply both.

For rotation and zoom, compute:

```
CA = COS(angle) / scale
SA = SIN(angle) / scale
DU_COL = CA * 65536
DV_COL = SA * 65536
DU_ROW = -SA * 65536
DV_ROW = CA * 65536
```

To keep the texture centre (TC, TC) at the centre of a destination rectangle with half-width HW and half-height HH:

```
U0 = (TC - HW*CA + HH*SA) * 65536
V0 = (TC - HW*SA - HH*CA) * 65536
```

This is an affine transform. It rotates, scales, skews, and scrolls, but it does not do perspective.

### 4.6.17 A Mode 7 BASIC example

This program builds a 64 x 64 checkerboard texture in memory, turns on the 320 x 200 VideoChip mode, and renders the texture rotated into the framebuffer:

```
10 REM MODE7 CHECKERBOARD
20 TB=&H00500000:FB=&H00100000:FP=65536
30 W=320:H=200:T=64:TS=T*4
40 POKE &H000F0004,&H04
50 POKE &H000F0080,0
60 POKE &H000F0084,FB
70 POKE &H000F0000,1
80 FOR Y=0 TO T-1
90 FOR X=0 TO T-1
100 C=(INT(X/8)+INT(Y/8)) AND 1
110 IF C=0 THEN P=&H000000FF
120 IF C<>0 THEN P=&H0000FFFF
130 POKE TB+(Y*T+X)*4,P
140 NEXT X:NEXT Y
150 A=.55:SC=1.15
160 CA=COS(A)/SC:SA=SIN(A)/SC
170 DC=INT(CA*FP):DS=INT(SA*FP)
180 HW=W/2:HH=H/2:TC=T/2
190 U0=INT((TC-HW*CA+HH*SA)*FP)
200 V0=INT((TC-HW*SA-HH*CA)*FP)
210 BLIT MODE7 TB,FB,W,H,U0,V0,DC,DS,0-DS,DC,T-1,T-1,TS,W*4
220 PRINT PEEK(&H000F0044)
```

Line 210 is the whole Mode 7 operation. DC and DS are the fixed-point cosine and sine terms. 0-DS is the negative sine term for DU\_ROW. T-1 gives masks 63,63, which wrap the 64 x 64 texture. TS is the source stride (64 \* 4), and W\*4 is the destination stride (320 \* 4). The final PRINT should show 2, meaning BLT\_STATUS.DONE is set and ERR is clear.

## 4.7 The copper list

The blitter changes memory when your program asks it to. The copper changes registers while the display is being drawn. Use it when a horizontal split, colour bar, palette change, or per-scanline effect must happen at a raster position instead of at the next convenient BASIC line.

The copper is a scanline-driven register writer. It reads a list of 32-bit words from main memory. During each frame it waits for raster positions and writes MMIO registers. Use it for raster colour bars, mid-frame palette changes, display splits, and per-scanline setup that should not burn CPU time.

BASIC has a copper-list builder:

| BASIC form             | Effect                                                 |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| COPPER LIST addr       | Set COPPER_PTR and set the BASIC build cursor to addr. |
| COPPER WAIT y          | Append a wait for scanline y, X position 0.            |
| COPPER MOVE addr,value | Append a write to absolute MMIO address addr.          |
| COPPER END             | Append an end word.                                    |

| BASIC form | Effect              |
|------------|---------------------|
| COPPER ON  | Enable the copper.  |
| COPPER OFF | Disable the copper. |

COPPER MOVE accepts MMIO addresses at or above \$000A0000. It emits a SETBASE for the exact address, then emits a MOVE with register index 0. This is larger than hand-packed copper code, but it is easy to type and can target VideoChip or other MMIO blocks.

### 4.7.1 Copper control and status

| Register      | Meaning                                                 |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| COPPER_CTRL   | Bit 0 enables. Bit 1 resets/latches the staged pointer. |
| COPPER_PTR    | Address of the first copper word.                       |
| COPPER_PC     | Address of the next copper word.                        |
| COPPER_STATUS | Running, waiting, and halted bits.                      |

Enabling the copper latches COPPER\_PTR into COPPER\_PC and clears waiting/halted state. At the start of every frame, the copper starts again from COPPER\_PTR, clears waiting/halted state, and resets its MMIO base to \$000F0000.

COPPER\_STATUS has three read-only bits:

| Bit | Name    | Meaning                                              |
|-----|---------|------------------------------------------------------|
| 0   | RUNNING | The copper is enabled and not halted.                |
| 1   | WAITING | The copper is paused on a WAIT instruction.          |
| 2   | HALTED  | The copper has hit END (or a bad opcode) this frame. |

### 4.7.2 Copper instruction words

Each copper instruction is a 32-bit word. The top two bits select the opcode:

| Top bits | Opcode  | Length  | Effect                                                                  |
|----------|---------|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 00       | WAIT    | 1 word  | Wait until raster reaches (Y,X).                                        |
| 01       | MOVE    | 2 words | Write the following data word to $\text{IO\_BASE} + \text{index} * 4$ . |
| 10       | SETBASE | 1 word  | Change IO_BASE.                                                         |
| 11       | END     | 1 word  | Halt until the next frame.                                              |

Word layouts:

| Instruction | Word layout                                             |
|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| WAIT        | bits 23-12 = Y, bits 11-0 = X.                          |
| MOVE        | bits 23-16 = register index. The next word is the data. |
| SETBASE     | bits 23-0 = base >> 2. The base must be 4-byte aligned. |
| END         | \$C0000000.                                             |



The wait test is current Y > wait Y, or current Y = wait Y and current X >= wait X. BASIC COPPER WAIT only emits X 0. Hand written copper lists may use any 12-bit X value.

If IO\_BASE is \$000F0000, MOVE register index 15 writes \$000F003C, which is BLT\_COLOR. A hand-packed move to BLT\_COLOR therefore uses word \$400F0000, followed by the colour word.

### 4.7.3 A copper colour-bar example

This program clears the screen, builds a copper list, and lets the copper draw three horizontal bands by changing the raster-band colour at selected scanlines.

```
10 REM COPPER RASTER BANDS
20 FB=&H00100000:CL=&H00380000:ST=320*4
30 POKE &H000F0004,&H04
40 POKE &H000F0080,0
50 POKE &H000F0084,FB
60 POKE &H000F0000,1
70 BLIT FILL FB,320,200,&H00000000,ST
80 COPPER LIST CL
90 COPPER WAIT 0
100 COPPER MOVE &H000F0048,0
110 COPPER MOVE &H000F004C,67
120 COPPER MOVE &H000F0050,&H000000AA
130 COPPER MOVE &H000F0054,1
140 COPPER WAIT 67
150 COPPER MOVE &H000F0048,67
160 COPPER MOVE &H000F004C,66
170 COPPER MOVE &H000F0050,&H0000AA00
180 COPPER MOVE &H000F0054,1
190 COPPER WAIT 133
200 COPPER MOVE &H000F0048,133
210 COPPER MOVE &H000F004C,67
220 COPPER MOVE &H000F0050,&H00AA0000
230 COPPER MOVE &H000F0054,1
240 COPPER END
250 COPPER ON
260 PRINT PEEK(&H000F0018)
```

The list writes VIDEO\_RASTER\_Y, VIDEO\_RASTER\_HEIGHT, VIDEO\_RASTER\_COLOR, and VIDEO\_RASTER\_CTRL at three scanlines. The final status print usually shows 1 immediately after enabling because the copper is running; after a frame reaches COPPER END, bit 2 (HALTED) is set until the next frame restart.

### 4.7.4 Hand-packed copper example

The same mechanism can be entered directly as words. This short list waits for scanline 100, writes BLT\_COLOR, and ends:

```
10 CL=&H00390000
20 POKE CL+0,&H00064000
30 POKE CL+4,&H400F0000
40 POKE CL+8,&H000000FF
50 POKE CL+12,&HC00000000
60 POKE &H000F0010,CL
70 POKE &H000F000C,1
```

\$00064000 is WAIT 100,0. \$400F0000 is MOVE register index 15, and the following word is the data to write.

## 4.8 The raster band

The raster band is a single-shot horizontal fill. It is separate from the blitter and is especially useful from copper lists.

| Register            | Meaning                                        |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| VIDEO_RASTER_Y      | First scanline to fill.                        |
| VIDEO_RASTER_HEIGHT | Number of scanlines. 0 means 1.                |
| VIDEO_RASTER_COLOR  | RGBA32 colour, or CLUT8 index in the low byte. |
| VIDEO_RASTER_CTRL   | Write bit 0 to start the fill.                 |

In RGBA32 mode, the band writes VIDEO\_RASTER\_COLOR as pixels. In CLUT8 mode, it writes the low byte of VIDEO\_RASTER\_COLOR as the palette index. If Y is outside the current mode, the request is ignored. If the band extends past the bottom of the screen, it is clipped at the bottom.

Example:

```
10 FB=&H00100000:ST=320*4
20 POKE &H000F0004,&H04
30 POKE &H000F0080,0
40 POKE &H000F0084,FB
50 POKE &H000F0000,1
60 POKE &H000F0048,90
70 POKE &H000F004C,20
80 POKE &H000F0050,&H0000FFFF
90 POKE &H000F0054,1
```

This fills scanlines 90 through 109 with cyan.

## 4.9 VIDEO\_STATUS

VIDEO\_STATUS is read-only and reports three bits:

| Bit | Name        | Meaning                                                                   |
|-----|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0   | HAS_CONTENT | At least one pixel has been written to VRAM since the chip was enabled.   |
| 1   | VBLANK      | The chip is currently in the vertical-retrace interval.                   |
| 2   | FB_ERR      | The framebuffer source is unreachable or undersized for the current mode. |

The VBLANK bit is the safest place to poll if you have no interrupt handler installed and need to wait for the retrace.

FB\_ERR is useful when using FB\_BASE. It is set when the selected framebuffer does not contain enough bytes for the current mode and colour mode. For example, 1920 x 1080 RGBA32 needs 8,294,400 bytes, so it cannot fit wholly inside the five-megabyte VRAM window. Point FB\_BASE at ordinary memory with enough space, or use CLUT8.

## 4.10 Putting it together

A minimal "set a mode, load a palette, draw a frame" sequence from machine language looks like this:

1. Write VIDEO\_MODE and FB\_BASE.
2. Write COLOR\_MODE (0 for RGBA32, non-zero for CLUT8).

3. If CLUT8: write 256 palette entries via PAL\_INDEX/PAL\_DATA.
4. Write VIDEO\_CTRL = 1.
5. Fill the framebuffer with whatever you want to display.
6. Optionally start the copper to change registers per-scanline, start the blitter for fast copies, or program a raster band.

Chapter 24 describes how the address constants above appear in machine-language programs. Chapter 10 shows how tile and sprite layers map onto the framebuffer.